Possession

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/41748966.

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Mature

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Minor or Background Relationship(s)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
BDSM, Dom Catra (She-Ra), Sub Adora (She-Ra), Modern AU but still Canon Species, Romantic Fluff, One Shot, Established Relationship, Engagement, Collar play

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Part 2 of Do It For Me - BDSM series

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Catradora AUs by n7punk

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Summary

Catra has wanted to marry Adora since they were kids. It was one of the many things that made their breakup feel like such a cruel joke. They've been back together for two years now, though, and she has no doubts they're going to last this time. She just has to figure out how to propose.
Adora throws her for a loop when she says she wants to get married, but she doesn't want a wedding.
(Or, a kink alternative to a Catradora wedding. Sequel fic to "Beg For Me")

Notes

(Not intended to be standalone). Like always with this series, these aren't necessarily my feelings on any of this, but it felt right for this AU. Also, I'm once again making some wording choices related to BDSM I *know* to be incorrect either because, like before, the grammar goes against normal rules and bugs my OCD too much, or because it feels right for their relationship in particular. Like normally I think Catra and Adora are both wedding people (if secretly, on Catra's part) but the stress of being involved with one is just too much for Adora to deal with in this AU.
CW pregnancy mention (for Glimmer) and implied choking/breathplay.

See the end of the work for more notes

Scorpia and Perfuma get married shortly before their official two-year anniversary. Adora isn't really a part of it, but Catra is Scorpia's best man, so Adora gets a front row seat to the trainwreck-in-action that just barely holds together. The final wedding is beautiful and Adora is sure most of the guests have no idea how many things almost – or did – go wrong, but she does think that reception area is just dark enough that people might suspect that something is wrong with the lights rather than thinking it is merely an aesthetic choice.

After dealing with the tight-packed anxiety of Glimmer and Bow's wedding and having watched Catra nearly tear her hair out trying to deal with all the fires – mostly metaphorical, but one literal – that cropped up during Scorpia's and Perfuma's, Adora doesn't even think twice about saying that she never wants to deal with a wedding again as they collapse in their hotel room afterwards. At the time, Catra merely chuckled in response.

They're cuddling in bed a week later, half naked despite what they were just doing because they just couldn't wait to get fully undressed, when it comes up again. Adora has her face down in Catra's stomach, nuzzling into her fur and humming to herself softly as she soaks in the afterglow. Catra's hands have been absently carding through her hair as she waits for Adora to make her way back up to the head of the bed and give her the assurance that has become part of their routine, but her hands stilled a few moments ago and now she is just lying there cupping the back of Adora's head. She shocks Adora when she opens her mouth.

"Would you ever want to marry me?" Catra asks, her voice barely above a whisper. Adora freezes in the middle of rubbing her cheek into Catra's soft fluff, blinking out at the side of the room. She was taking a few minutes to enjoy herself before she moved onto Catra's portion of the aftercare like they normally do, but clearly she was taking *too long* because that question requires a deep level of doubt she didn't think Catra had about them anymore.

"I mean, you said you never wanted to [illegible] with a wedding again," Catra elaborates, an edge of nervousness in her tone that wasn't there—or was better hidden—when she first spoke. It clicks into place for Adora then. It has been five days since they drove back from Plumeria, leaving Scorpia and Perfuma behind to celebrate their honeymoon. Adora suspects that Catra has been thinking—and likely worrying—about this ever since the wedding.

It wasn't a question that Adora expected to pop up while they were soaking in the afterglow. She lifts her head, shifting up so she can hold Catra and make eye contact. Her immediate instinct is to say [illegible] and cuddle her until all her doubts disappear, but Catra's body is unyielding and stiff with anxiety when Adora tries to pull her into her arms. Catra doesn't pull away at least, watching Adora just as carefully as Adora is watching her now.

Adora doesn't have much to mull over in the "Do you want to get married" question, but there was a reason she made that initial comment, and it wasn't just temporary exhaustion from a weekend of anxiety. Adora reaches out, petting down Catra's arm since hugging isn't going to be enough to soothe her.

"I want to marry you, I just don't like weddings. They usually end up so stressful that I can't wait until they're over. I want marrying you to just be happy," Adora assures. Catra immediately lets out a shaky breath of relief, the stiffness in her body dissipating with it. Adora quickly wraps an arm around her now that she has relaxed enough for it to do something. Catra offers her a smile that starts thin and then spreads wide, lighting up her entire face.

Adora isn't surprised when she leans up and kisses her, throwing her arms around her shoulders. Within a few moments Adora is being pushed to roll over onto her back, a purring Catra crawling into her lap and kissing her slowly. Adora happily cuddles her back, kissing her until she is breathless and then resting their cheeks together so they can remain just as close. It's the portion of the night where Catra usually gets cuddles anyway. Adora lets her eyes fall closed as she listens to the purr that is humming from Catra now.

"I love you so much. I've always wanted to marry you. I don't want coordinating catering and faulty lighting choices to overshadow that moment, but I'd still be willing to do it if that's what you really wanted. I'm sure we could make it work with something small," Adora promises her, once the fluttering in her chest has settled down enough to. Catra's purr grows louder as she rubs her cheek against Adora, scent marking her in a clear acceptance of the statement. It relieves her a bit. She thought Catra would have known that after so long together.

"We don't have to do all that. I kind of just assumed we would have one, but a wedding doesn't matter to me, not as long as I can have you forever," Catra promises her , pulling back just enough to make eye contact, though their chests are still pressed together. Adora is sure that Catra can feel her heart racing, if she can't outright hear it. She can certainly hear it pounding in her own ears. It isn't anxiety , though there is an edge of panic in her body right now.

"Are you proposing?" she asks, hopeful , because she doesn't think Catra is, but this certainly feels like a conversation that could lead to that – either soon, or in a year when Catra tells her that she isn't ready yet. Catra basically just declared her intent either way . Not that Adora had any doubts that they were in it for the long haul, but Catra doubted them once and this is proof that she really is past that. Catra's eyes widen, her ears twitching as her pupils dilate. Adora bites her lip as Catra's tail whips to the side.

"Not.yet," Catra finally replies, hesitance in her voice. Adora slowly releases a breath and nods. There's an edge in Catra's expression, uncertainty or doubt, and it inspires the same feeling in Adora. "I do want to be with you forever. It's all I've wanted since I was a kid," Catra adds on, the promise quiet. Adora's heartrate increases again, but at the same time her body relaxes. She leans forward to kiss Catra's cheek and then pulls back to re-establish eye contact.

"Me too. I know , given everything, that you probably need time. I'm going to be here for it, no matter how long you need," Adora promises her. The tension returning to Catra's body was subtle, but

given how they're pressed together , Adora still feels it releasing all the same. Catra's expression softens. As much as she likes to pretend that she is hard and untouchable to the world, as much as she likes to be dominate and in control, she is also incredibly soft. Over the two years they have been together again now, she has gotten better at letting herself show her vulnerable side. In this moment, she doesn't pretend not to be touched by her words.

"I don't know that I need more time, I just... want to think about it, I guess. Things have been so good, I've just been comfortable with how they are," Catra admits. Adora nods. She can't lie that she hasn't thought the word *wife* with some giddiness over the last few months – and with growing frequency – but their relationship is good as it currently stands. She certainly hopes getting married wouldn't change that – at least not for the worse – but until Catra is thinking of it with the same positivity, she is happy to wait.

"Whenever you want to talk about it, I'm here. I'm not going to spring anything on you until you're sure, but I've thought about it since before Perfuma and Scorpia even got engaged," Adora tells her . Catra's pupils are round again as she blinks back at Adora, a subtle buzzing in her chest.

"Okay ," she agrees, the kind of quiet *okay* that carries weight and tells Adora that Catra is going to be thinking about that for the next week. She smiles and shifts her arms so she can run her hands up and down Catra's back, even though it unfortunately means that she can't hug her close anymore.

"I love you," she promises. Catra' s purr grows louder.

"I love you too," she replies, voice just as quiet as before. Adora tugs on Catra and is pleased when she shuffles a little closer to drape over her and cuddle much the same way that Adora likes to when they're doing aftercare.

"You're a great dom and I'm lucky to be your sub," she adds, because while this was definitely a form of it, they haven't actually

done their usual aftercare yet. Catra snorts, her tail whipping side to side as she nips half-heartedly at Adora's shoulder.

"Brat," she accuses, probably because that point has kind of already been made, but Adora would rather say it too much than too little. Adora could easily point out that statement could go both ways – Catra is a brat more frequently than she is, too – but instead she runs her hand over Catra's hair, pushing it away from her face in the process.

"You like it when you can put me back in my place," Adora returns, smiling as she kisses the newly-revealed base of Catra's ear. Catra rumbles with amusement, but she doesn't respond. They make it a policy not to lie to each other, so Catra has nothing she can say that isn't admitting defeat. She hates doing that.

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Catra has been thinking about her and Adora's wedding since she was maybe eight. Not that she was planning what they would wear or anything, mostly just thinking about a time when they could show off to everybody that they were in love and Adora was hers. It wasn't about having a wedding for her, but weddings were what being happy and together for forever looked like to her as a child. Love was simpler when she didn't understand it. Now she knows it is something that they have to give each other in actions, words, and commitment every day for it to mean anything.

A wedding is just one event and it doesn't prove how much you love each other. She hasn't even really thought about weddings since they were kids, but lately she has caught herself thinking of Adora as her wife whenever she pictured any hypothetical point in the future. She wouldn't have considered thinking about this until they had been together again for longer than they were last time, but they passed

that mark a few months ago and Catra doesn't have doubts about their relationship anymore.

She wants to marry Adora – *eventually*, now, *soon*, whenever – and she never really thought that Adora would have a problem with that until her offhand comment. She didn't know if Adora really meant it or if it was just a long weekend. She kind of forgot that you can get married without a wedding. In her defense, she doesn't know a single person who considered not having one aside from Huntara, who has forgone the institution of marriage completely, but it's fairly common for people in the kink scene to take unconventional routes, so that argument is pretty weak. It should have occurred to her. She was too busy being anxious to think about it, but now Adora has assured her, she is thinking more and more about what they could do instead of fearing the answer is *nothing*.

They could just get married, end of story. Go to the courthouse and get it done. Adora's issues with weddings are truthfully Catra's issues too. She doesn't want Adora to think that getting engaged means she has to go through that kind of stress, but part of her does still want that "celebration of love" that she always imagined weddings to be. Whatever they do should be simple and just about them. It should have meaning and most importantly, Catra doesn't want to involve of ballroom full a people and the logistics attached to them in it. Maybe a few people, sure, but maybe none. After all, this is about their happiness. They don't have families pressuring them to have a big event or invite all their cousins and they should take advantage of that, even if Catra knows that a number of their friends will be disappointed they don't do some kind of party.

When Catra hesitates for ideas, neither eloping nor having a small private ceremony feeling right, she turns to the community that she knows often circumvents the norm for a solution.

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Adora is trying to help Glimmer arrange her baby shower, but Catra seems to have other ideas. They are on the couch, Adora leaning back in Catra's arms and texting the group chat, but the hands that were wrapped around her waist at first have wandered. One is on her thigh, running up and down the inner seam of her pants almost absently, but Catra isn't *done*. She doesn't run her fingers along any interesting texture she can find. No, Catra is torturing her, and the proof is in how Catra's other arm is wrapped around her torso so her claws can lightly trail over the far side of Adora's neck. They both know how much Adora likes it when Catra touches her there in a number of ways.

"Do you need something?" Adora asks, the edge of a special kind of frustration in her voice as she shifts and dislodges Catra's hand from her thigh. Catra chuckles, seeming to take it as a challenge. Within a moment, her hand is running just under the seam again, and this time she traces all the way to the center seam. If it weren't for her jeans, Adora would be able to *feel* Catra's fingers right over her, but they are offering her no relief from the fidgety need that has been building up as Catra touched her.

"Mm, I think I do," Catra decides, her fingers lightly rubbing over the center seam now. Adora's face is red as she texts the group chat that she's going to go work out and she'll help Glimmer find a food option that works for everybody later. She hopes that Glimmer buys it. She thinks it is a pretty good lie, but she also knows that she isn't capable of higher thought when Catra is playing with her like this. Her ponytail is still up, so maybe Catra is just horny. They don't dip into BDSM every time they have sex by a long shot, though Adora would kind of like to right now after feeling Catra's hand on her neck for so long.

"I need you," Catra's hand slips around her neck so she can place her thumb on one side and her fingertips on the other, "collared," she finishes, her tone smug in Adora's ear as she squeezes just enough for Adora to feel the pressure on either side of her neck. Like always,

it immediately shuts off any parts of her brain that function on more than base instinct. Adora lets out a quiet moan, her eyes fluttering shut.

"Please," she breathes without hesitation. She wasn't thinking about it before Catra gave her the tease of pressure on her neck, at least not consciously, but now she needs it more than anything. Their play collars might be Adora's favorite material object. Catra's paintings don't count, that goes beyond material, but she loves what the collars make her feel. Everything—stressful baby shower planning, for instance—stops mattering when she has one around her neck. They have three different styles, though they mostly only vary in decoration and attachment points.

"Always so eager to be collared," Catra chuckles, and for a minute Adora worries that Catra is going to make her beg for it, but clearly she can tell that Adora has been teased enough and needs some relief, because her hands leave Adora's body and reach up to undo her ponytail. "Come on, princess. You're wearing too many clothes," Catra encourages her. Adora doesn't need further instructions, eagerly standing up and shoving her phone into her pocket as soon as her ponytail holder comes off. Her phone chimes as she does so, but she really doesn't give a shit about what Glimmer has to say right now.

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Catra doesn't know if she ever had a client who loves the collar as much as Adora does. Some were more eager to be collared, definitely, and she had one or two who came to her exclusively for that back when she used to do private sessions, but what a professional dom can do with a play collar in one session isn't the same as what can be done in a long-term relationship. There's a ***[illegible]*** that comes with the collar that goes beyond the scene.

An immediate peace always hits Adora when the collar wraps around her neck. She becomes Catra's in an instant, all her worries and even some of her desires left behind. Now *h*C *s* desires are what's important. It works really well for her.

Catra has been thinking about this a lot over the last few days as *o*h ideas formed in the back of her head. She has been looking at options, mostly online, and she has found a couple that she thinks they would both like, but it has put the idea of playing with Adora like this at the forefront of her mind and she needs to do it to be satisfied right now.

The moan Adora gives when Catra tugs on her leash, pulling her to the foot of the bed, makes Catra's tail lash. Watching Adora squirm a little as Catra loops the handle of the leash to the bed post – tying her up and making it clear that she's going to be waiting while Catra has her fun – Catra knows that it wont be a wasted purchase even if they dont end up using it like she planned. There will still be days where it gets use regardless. Now she just needs to figure out how the hell she is going to surprise Adora with this while also having a serious conversation about it.

Well, and she needs to decide how much she wants to torture Adora today, but if she doesnt decide, that just means she is drawing it out until Adora cant take another moment and tries to demand relief. That works for Catra.

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There has been a package tucked into Catra' s painting supplies for at least four days now. It isnt big, just a small box in an organza drawstring bag that looks suspiciously like it could hold jewelry , but Adora still noticed it. She isnt sure if Catra expected her to or not. Adora doesnt have reason to poke around in there, but she

happened to look down when she came in to cuddle Catra while she was painting.

Adora knows what she thinks it is – she can't figure out *what* he *would* – but she is still kind of shocked by its presence. She was ready to get married probably a few months after her first art show, but she knew Catra wasn't, so she didn't really think about it. Whenever Catra was ready, she assumed they would have a conversation about it, and soon one of them would be proposing. She didn't realize the conversation they had after Perfuma's wedding was *the* conversation.

She thought the fact that Catra had a doubt like that was proof enough that it wasn't time yet. She thought Catra outright said that she didn't want to get married quite yet – though she was thinking about it now – in that conversation. A jewelry box is hiding in Catra's painting supplies, however, and neither of them wear any normally. It *has* to be a ring. Adora wants it more than anything, but she is a little nervous when she thinks about it, mostly because wearing a ring seems difficult to adjust to.

Would Catra be offended, or worse, feel insecure if she doesn't wear it? She wants to *try*, but she doesn't know she'll be successful. They have been happy together for almost two years now. Getting married is partially – maybe *wholly* – about affirming that they want to be together forever. Adora has learned how badly Catra needs affirmations in a relationship. She is worried about turning a piece of such a big one away. She really wants to talk to her about it, but she doesn't want to ruin whatever Catra is planning either.

She has been thinking about it so much that she glances down without thinking about it when she comes home to find Catra painting. She furrows her brow upon seeing *nothing*. The box is gone now. Catra, standing a few feet away in front of her canvas, turns around to greet Adora and sighs.

"Alright, how long did you know?" she asks. Adora realizes how obvious she just was, sending Catra a sheepish expression.

"Five days. I didn't open it. I mean, I know what it is, but I didn't peek," she rushes to assure her. To her surprise, Catra smirks and turns away, dipping her brush in the water cup hanging off the side of her easel.

"You don't know what it is. Give me a few minutes to finish up and we'll talk," Catra says, casually dismissing what Adora has been worrying for the last few days. She blinks at Catra's back. If it *is* that – or something along those lines – she doesn't know why Catra would hide it from her. It isn't her birthday, or their anniversary, or any other gift-giving holiday. Sometimes they get gifts for each other without an occasion, but when they do that, they don't hang onto it and hide it like this. This is *something*.

"Change, Adora. I'll meet you when I'm done," Catra adds without turning around. Right. Adora is just standing here in her office slacks. If she has to wait anyway, she might as well change, but she would prefer to know what is going on. Reluctantly, she turns away and makes her way back to the bedroom. As she changes into sweats, the confusion of the last few minutes fades enough for disappointment to set in. She wanted- she *was* to marry Catra. It seemed like it was finally about to happen.

Then again, Catra didn't seem *bad* by Adora's guess. She seemed amused, if anything. There might still be a chance. Adora tries to keep her expectations moderate as she finishes. Catra might be ready soon even if it's not right now. She returns to the living room to wait for Catra. The sunroom is now empty, but Adora can hear sound in the kitchen, so Catra is probably washing off her brushes and will come join her after she has brought them back.

When Catra walks through the room, Adora's eyes snap to her and she smirks. She has her brushes, but she is also carrying the box, its organza bag hooked off her pinky finger by the drawstring. It's a little big for a ring now that Adora thinks about it, but she never got a close look at it before, just stolen glances. It certainly isn't the traditional velvet box that she is used to seeing on TV, but she assumed Catra just didn't get something very expensive. Adora

certainly couldn't be trusted to keep a diamond ring in good shape, but she's just confused now.

Catra returns to the living room with her smug smile still in place and sits beside her on the couch, tucking one leg under herself and dangling the other over the side so she can sit facing Adora. Adora turns to face her too as Catra pulls on the drawstring and slides the box out of its bag.

"I've been trying to figure out how to do this. I was going to bring it up over dinner tonight. I didn't know you'd already seen it," Catra says, casually, finally setting the bag aside and holding the box out to Adora with it framed in her hands. Adora's heart beats quickly as she cautiously reaches out. The way Catra is holding it is firm, so instead of trying to take it, she reaches for the lid instead. Catra tilts the box a little to help her lift it as it sticks for a moment. Adora pretty much forgets the lid exists once she pulls it off and finally sees what's inside.

A gold necklace sits inside the box, most of the chain hidden behind the black cushion it is resting on. The ends of the chain wrap around a small ring pendant in the center of the cushion. It takes Adora several seconds, during which Catra's tail twitches nervously, before she connects the delicate profile of the necklace to the *ring* hanging in its center.

"Is this-" Adora starts, stops, and looks up to make eye contact with Catra. Her eyes are sparkling – *bring* – as she watches Adora. She is a little tense, but she manages a teasing smile.

"A day collar, yes, Adora. I know your brain turns off when a collar comes out, but it can only be so subtle," Catra replies, sarcasm in her voice but her tail dangerously still. She's trying to be casual and she absolutely isn't, not when she is watching Adora's reaction like this. Adora swallows and looks back down at the collar. It is dainty and features a very small ring. She isn't sure a finger could even be hooked through it, though a leash could still attach to it even if it doesn't look like it could take being pulled on like that. She would

argue that it's subtle enough that she wouldn't recognize it on the street, but given the context, she suspected. There's just one problem.

"I thought you didn't want to," she responds even as she reaches for the pendant. Catra, because she is *her*, pulls it back. Adora immediately drops her hand – because she knows and *loves* the rules when it comes to their collars, and because she is unsure enough about what's happening that she wants to wait until Catra explains it – but she can't hide her disappointment. It only proves Catra's earlier point right and causes her to smirk as she – *no* – reaches for the lid that Adora forgot existed and covers the collar again.

"I know I said a day collar doesn't make sense outside of a twenty-four-seven BDSM relationship, and I kind of still believe that, but... I want you to be *mine*, Adora. Always. You have my heart, and even though these typically aren't presented with the phrase '*just do it*', for me, this is a symbol of how much we both trust and love each other," Catra tells her. Adora's heartrate picks up again as she looks up from the box to make eye contact with Catra again. Her gaze is burning and her expression is hopeful. "It's an engagement necklace," she finally adds, her voice low as she confirms everything that Adora was beginning to hope over the last few days.

Adora sucks in a breath and then tears spring to her eyes.

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Despite being a professional in the BDSM space – she hasn't done play sessions since her lease running out coincided with her getting into an art show, but she still does bachelorette parties when Huntara or Bonnie sends an offer her way – there are some kinks that Catra just isn't comfortable with. It's human nature, she

supposes, to be weirded out by the idea of some things that turn other people on, and she has done research into them so she could cover them in her sessions, but she doesn't want them in her personal life.

Given her childhood – *her* childhood, a shared trauma and abuse that is always going to exist in her memories no matter how well-adjusted she manages to become – she doesn't ever want a full-time BDSM relationship. BDSM is fun and has improved both their lives – and their shared life – so much, but it is strictly something for the bedroom, or for when she wants to toy with Adora leading *up* to sex. Catra doesn't want to take control of Adora outside of that context. She doesn't need to feed into the possessive side of herself like that, and having grown up tightly under someone else's control, the idea kind of panics her. As soon as she explained it like that, Adora understood, and she never brought a day collar up again, content with what they already had.

Catra reached a compromise in her mind long ago. The collar she used to use for clients was obviously hers. Once she bought one just for Adora, she started thinking of it as *her's* even though convention says it should belong to Catra as the dominant. It was just a play collar and it didn't have to follow the rules of a kind of relationship that they don't even have anyway. BDSM is incredibly individual. It's about what works for *them* and this is the only engagement gift that made sense to her.

"I can't believe this is how you chose to propose, you *dork*, and you won't even let me have it," Adora both teases and complains as she makes grabby hands towards the box that Catra is now holding out of her reach – which is difficult, considering that Adora is now laying on her and has longer arms than her – but she isn't making a serious effort to reach for it. Catra raises a brow at her.

"I'm a dork when you're begging to be collared?" she asks, watching the delightful flush on Adora's face up close. Adora, maturely, pouts, which is definitely in Catra's top ten favorite expressions on her. She has cried, and asked Catra if she is sure and this is really happening

three times now, and they've kissed too, but Adora is finally starting to eqalize again as they cuddle. She has enough presence of mind to remember the necklace that Catra proposed with and to get bratty over it.

"You're a dork because you're emotionally constipated. Let me try it? Please?" Adora responds. Catra snorts. She has gotten a lot better at talking about things, but she really didn't know how to ask Adora, and Adora finding the necklace early threw her whole plan off.

"After we've talked about it," she promises, ducking forward to kiss Adora's cheek before she pointedly drops her arm and sets the box aside on the couch cushion. Adora's eyes light up, finally looking away from the box to watch her expectedly. Catra takes a moment to gather herself. She wants to say this right and not stumble through it like she just did the initial proposal.

"I couldn't think of any other gift that made sense, but I don't want you to actually feel like I'm collaring you with it. You know I want things eqal between us when I'm not domming you. If you don't end up liking how it feels to wear it, then we could use it for days when I want to torture you instead, but aside from that, I wanted it to be our necklace. I want people to see it on your neck and know you're my wife," Catra explains, because making sure that Adora knows the main thing she wants right now is to their last names is important to her. Adora's smile is soft but beaming.

"It's a fantastic gift. I couldn't think of anything better. I don't know yet if I'll like wearing it all the time, but I definitely want to try. If I don't, playing with it will be plenty for me," Adora promises her, almost babbling, because she gets like that when she's excited. It makes Catra's chest warm to see her so happy over this. Her tail flicks to betray her emotions, but she isn't trying to hide them right now. Catra nods.

"I know you said you didn't want a wedding," she adds, starts, stops. Adora's eyes light up and she grins. Catra huffs, rolling her eyes even as she loops her arms around Adora and holds her for a

moment. Maybe she's jumping the gun to talk about all of this right now, but she has spent a few weeks thinking about it and she feels ready. They will plan for as long as Adora needs, but Adora has to know what Catra wants to plan in the first place.

"Even treating it like an engagement necklace, it is a kinky one. I was thinking we could do a private collaring ceremony instead of a wedding. Something just for the two of us, and we could say our vows without having an audience," Catra asks, watching the way Adora's eyes dilate with some relief. She really wasn't sure how Adora would feel about that idea, but she smirks upon seeing her reaction. To her surprise, Adora smirks back.

"Emotionally constipated," she points out. Right. Catra huffs, rolling her eyes as her tail lashes to the side. Wanting to keep their vows private isn't about that, not really.

"I want to be able to say everything. I won't feel like I can do that in front of other people, but I want you to know how much I love you," she admits, halfway glaring at Adora, because *ugh*, she talked about her emotions. Adora's expression is akin to awe, though, so it's worth it, especially when a smile slowly blossoms on her face and she ducks forward to kiss Catra on her nose.

"I'd love that. I think it might be nice to, I don't know, just go out for dinner with our friends to celebrate, but that's all the ceremony that I need," Adora agrees. Catra purrs softly as she ducks forward herself now to rub their cheeks together and mark Adora.

"We can do the parts of weddings we always found romantic without having to spend a grand – and our *parents* – on it," Catra agrees. Adora smiles softly, nodding. As soon as Catra knew she was ready to make things official with Adora and started looking at alternatives, turning them over in her mind to see what felt right now, a collaring ceremony stood out. They don't exactly have a lot of friends in the kink scene though, so inviting their friends to it doesn't make much sense, and part of the point to all this is to avoid the stress of a big gathering. Just going to dinner is easy.

“W e have the collaring ceremony the morning before we go to the courthouse, and get dinner with whoever feels important that night” Catra offers, turning it over in her mind. A light shiver passes through Adora. Catra pulls back to drink in the dark look of anticipation in Adora’s eye, grinning to herself. If she had any doubt left over from their last conversation about marriage, it is dispelled now, because Adora clearly wants this.

“I’m not allowed to wear it until then, am I” Adora asks. It’ s a pointless question, but Catra still smirks as she answers it.

“Absolutely not. Y ou can try it on once to make sure it fits, and then it’s going back in the box” Adora’ s tongue darts out, wetting her lips as she glances down at the box

“How quickly can you get married in Bright Moon” she asks. Catra laughs, giddiness filling her chest as she happily tugs Adora close in a tight hug. She kisses the side of her face.

“W e can find out,” she promises her . She already waited until she didnt have any doubts about how much she wants this. She’ s excited just like Adora is.

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None of their friends are that surprised when they tell them they are engaged, nor when they tell them how quickly they want to get married. In the end, they wait nearly three weeks, mostly because that’s when they could get everyone together for dinner, but Adora also reluctantly agreed they should wait a week or two to make sure the reality of it had sunk in for both of them. Catra has spent the last few weeks planning this and picking out a necklace, so Adora is pretty sure that is for her benefit and she *knows* she isnt going to get cold feet, but if it gives Catra peace of mind then it’s worth it.

Besides, she likes calling Catra her fiancé—no matter how eager she is to upgrade to *wife*. Even doing things as informally as they are, it takes a little time to prepare. Catra floats the idea of them actually having an officiant for the collaring ceremony so they dont have to do the courthouse wedding, but the obvious choice for an officiant is either Huntara—who is in the kink scene and has facilitated these kinds of things at her dungeon before, but isnt already ordained—or Perfuma—who *is* ordained pretty much exclusively so she can get her friends married, but who they are less comfortable involving in something like this.

They might have talked kink with Perfuma once or twice, but her main thing is rigging, and even if Scorpia is over Catra now and married, it's weird for all of them when they do anything intimate or sexual in front of her. The collaring ceremony is emotional even if they arent using a collar in a traditional way, but there is an edge of kink to it. Besides, the license needs two witnesses in addition to an officiant, which means bringing even more people into their private ceremony. It wouldnt have the stress of planning a wedding still, but it seems better to have a real ceremony for themselves and then get the legal part done with a justice of the peace.

In the end, Adora takes a four-day weekend and they dress up on Friday morning, Catra in the tux she got for Scorpia's wedding and Adora in a simple white dress that she picked out with Glimmer the weekend before. It's not meant to be a wedding dress, but this isnt meant to be a wedding. Adora wanted something comfortable but still reminiscent of all the tradition they were bucking so they had something familiar. Catra and Adora *both* apparently secretly arranged flowers for delivery that morning, and they both laugh about it and then get a little teary eyed too.

After breakfast, and the flowers, and kissing and giggling over the flowers, they finally have their "ceremony" in the sunroom. They both wrote their vows down and Adora insists on going first because she knows she is going to cry a *lot* once Catra starts, but in the end she gets about two paragraphs in herself before she's crying because it's

finally happening. As weird as it is to be standing in their sunroom, all dressed up but alone and knowing in a few hours they're going to be signing their license, finally being able to marry Catra and knowing that Catra is now certain they're going to be together forever is such an intense emotion that she would be crying no matter how they chose to do this.

She is glad they did it in such an intimate setting, though, because it means they can stop and just hold each other as long as they want, crying as they say they love each other. For *a* Adora didn't think this would be possible again and it overwhelms her to watch it unfold before her, even if it is in the best way possible. She doesn't have any doubts, but hearing Catra's vows assuages her worries that Catra *h*. As soon as Catra starts, Adora understands why she didn't want to do this in front of other people. Talking about how much she loves Adora is expected for these things and makes her sniffly again, but then Catra gets to the time they were *a*.

"I lost so much of myself when I lost you. We were always one and the same before. Looking back on that time, it might have been the darkest in my life, and well. You know everything else I've been through. But it wasn't me, it was *s* going through it together, and that made all the difference," Catra says, her words wet because she's just as much of a mess as Adora. Adora makes her way back to crying in an instant, even if it's mostly silent and she *s* she's holding it together. Catra smiles, soft and apologetic and oh-so-loving as she shifts to press into Adora's side again, like they did when Adora first broke down. They *h* to face each other for this, but clearly that just isn't going to work, so they're pressed against each other with their hands intertwined. Adora's eyes are too watery for her to peek at Catra's notes anyway.

"It's easier to think about now, knowing we made our way back to each other and we've grown, but if I can find any silver lining in it, it's that it has made finally getting to marry you so meaningful. Even when we struggled since then, I knew and *k* know we are going to make it through, because I've seen life without you and I never want

to go back to that. Even when we were apart, I thought about you all the time. I never felt complete without you," Catra promises her , and now her eyes are watery enough that she has to stop and breathe. Adora hugs her, and then they're both crying all over again as they assure each other.

It's so *on* and it's hers – forever .

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Eventually they both stop being blubbering messes and Catra gets to ask Adora if she will be hers forever. When she says *wi*, Catra finally lifts the collar from the pillow it has sat on for three weeks, apparently taunting Adora, and clasps it around her neck.

"You're mine, and I am yours," she promises her when she cradles her jaw and finally brings her in for the kiss that would end the ceremony if this were a regular wedding, but it's not, so they stand there kissing each other for what must be ten minutes before they are finally stable – and happy , but not so happy that they're *jog* – enough for them to make their way into the living room, check in, and then make their way into the bedroom.

Catra really wants to see the o-ring swaying from Adora's neck, and though this is usually a wedding night activity, Catra considers them already married no matter what the license will say. They're going out with their friends tonight and are likely to just be exhausted from all the emotions – no matter how good they are – afterwards. They have time to kill before their appointment anyway. They planned to do their ceremony early so they had time to be exactly as emotional as they ended up being and it left them with a little extra time that they already knew how they would spend if they had it.

Adora looks beautiful, dress mostly undone but hanging around her waist thanks to the one sleeve she still partially has on, rocking back onto Catra's fingers as the necklace – and her tits – move exactly how Catra imagined. Catra tops, but she doesn't dom, because they're both too emotional for that right now.

Adora will get her turn with Catra when they come back from signing their license and have more time between that and the dinner with their friends. After that, the weekend is just for them. They'll do something for a honeymoon soon, probably, once they figure out what they actually want to do and can afford it, but right now they don't need to go anywhere to appreciate each other.

Catra gets to be as sappy as she wants today. That's the entire point of the day, to be in love and *show* it. She makes Adora hold still even when all she wants her to do is ride her fingers, leaning forward to press soft kisses up the line of her throat and scatter them across her cheeks. Adora, already all but melted for her, doesn't even think to protest that they stopped once Catra kisses her, sinking into the embrace just as eagerly.

Well, okay, she tries to twitch her hips once Catra is occupied with her mouth, but Catra is feeling lenient, so she lets her. On the long list of things that she loves about Adora, her eagerness is included. She can't imagine a better way this day could have gone than this, and it's barely halfway done.

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In the end, Adora thinks their wedding day ends up perfect. No part of it was traditional, but it also wasn't *for* either. It was just about them and what they wanted. Glimmer and Bow came over early before the dinner – after Adora had finished worshipping every inch of Catra's body – and helped them take wedding photos in their

backyard. The photos are only vaguely commemorative because Catra has already started her painting based off them that she plans to hang in the hall, but Adora prints them properly anyway so she can put them on her desk when she goes back to work.

She grins every time she glances over at it. She often finds herself lifting her hand to ghost her fingertips over the necklace hanging just below her throat. If it was any tighter, she doesn't know that she could have adjusted to it, but she can wear it for a few hours at least, so she has decided to just wear it when she is out of the house for now. Catra has been putting it on for her in the mornings and taking it off for her too. It's intimate, and echoes the rules they use with their play collars, but Adora also just can't figure out the clasp when she can't see it for herself.

"I can't believe I'm trying to get the nursery ready in time and you're wearing a collar to work," Glimmer complains when they meet up for lunch. Bow quickly glances up to make sure Adora's office door is closed all the way, but Adora just grins as she reaches up and runs her fingers over the center o-ring. Their friends definitely noticed her necklace when they all got dinner together, but for once they had some sense of decorum and didn't start teasing her over it in the fancy restaurant. The group chat, however, had no such restrictions. She and Catra spent the weekend largely focused on each other, though, so Adora wasn't really playing attention to it.

"Not my fault you guys are boring," she teases back, even though she feels just as excited for Glimmer and Bow to have their kid as they are. The kid is going to be her nephew no matter who his legal family is. Glimmer and Bow are settling down in a way that she and Catra likely never will, but they have similar lives of comfortable domesticity with their partners. If Glimmer can tease her about her necklace, then she can tease Glimmer about this.

"How dare you. I just spent the weekend putting glow-in-the-dark stars on the ceiling, that's *big*. If you're three, anyway," Glimmer returns. Adora snorts at the same time Bow turns to Glimmer with a

familiar heart-filled expression. He probably looked at her the exact same way when they were decorating the nursery.

"I'm sure Angel will love them in a few years," Adora says. She's being sincere. They would have been cool to have when she was a kid. They never had much. That's part of why she's excited to spoil Angel like only an aunt can do. Glimmer sniffs, seeming to decide that was enough appeasement to let the boring comment go and digging back into her lunch.

"Is it actually, um, you know?" Bow asks, not usually this awkward, but clearly he doesn't know how to phrase this question, though that's probably because they're at work. All their friends were at Glimmer's bachelorette party, and between Catra's profession and Adora's reactions that night, it was never a secret what they do in private. They all acknowledge it sometimes, usually to make jokes but occasionally when Catra wants to toy with her or when one of their friends has an *in* they want to ask about.

Of everyone they know, they've talked about kink the most around Glimmer and Bow just because they have that kind of relationship with each other where it isn't awkward. They're still pretty private about it all, but Glimmer and Bow know this isn't Adora's first collar, and they also know that some people involve BDSM in every part of their lives, even if Catra and Adora have never done that. They can recognize the necklace as a day collar, at least knowing *that*.

"No. I mean, it's made to be, but really it's just the only thing that fit for an engagement gift. I'm not wearing it all the time or anything," Adora tells him with a shrug. Glimmer snorts at the same time that Bow brightly smiles and nods. Adora doubts he was really worried about it, but it is the kind of thing that is especially hard for people outside of the community to understand. It's not the kind of relationship they have or want and she is sure he already knew that. It's probably where his doubt came from in the first place.

"Oh yeah, I'm sure there's *nothing* that would have worked," Glimmer replies, tone heavily sarcastic and a bit mocking, but she's

smiling. Adora shrugs. She really doesnt think there is. She cant imagine being happier than she is right now.

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If Catra is awake, the collar is the first thing that Adora puts on in the morning, right after she puts her hair up. Otherwise, Catra does it for her after breakfast. Catra prefers when she gets to put it on early, though, because it means she gets to see Adora with nothing but the chain on. The necklace is sturdy for its size, but still incredibly delicate as far as collars go. The clasp always takes her a moment to get right, but when she finishes, she drops a kiss to Adora's bare shoulder.

"Even though it marks you, it's my heart on your sleeve," Catra tells her, voice soft, because it's been enough days since the wedding for her to say something vulnerable again. She used up her quota, but she feels so much whenever she thinks about how they get to be together now, *always*, after all the years of feeling alone and unloved. Adora draws in a soft breath, the kind that Catra's ears always strain for.

"My collar and my wife," Catra adds, quietly, as she places her hands softly on Adora's hips and kisses the side of her neck now. Normally she thinks of the collars as *hers*, but she's having a moment right now, and *her* is included in theirs. Adora's gasp hitches her shoulders this time. She lifts a hand and covers Catra's on her hip with her own.

"Yours," she agrees in an instant, not a moment of doubt in her. A low purr rumbles in the air between them. Adora is going to need to get dressed for work in a second, but right now, Catra likes having her beneath her hands.

“*Yours*,” Catra returns. For all her possessive talk, it goes both ways. Thinking of herself as Adora’s wife is just as exciting as thinking of Adora as hers. When Adora speaks again, Catra can hear the smile in her voice.

“My wife,” she agrees, words dripping with affection. Instantly, Catra’s lashing tail relaxes and a warm purr fills the air.

End Notes

Adora's collar (sfw Etsy link but the recommended products/shops might be nsfw).
Yes Catra was Scorpia's best man because she gets to live her butchy dreams alright.
My whole knotwork headcannon didnt make an appearance here because it just would have crowded things when I already knew what I wanted to do instead, so for this AU usually you would propose with some form of ring or accessory, but it can vary a lot for hybrids especially. If your partner has their ears pierced or something, it's easy, but neither of them wear anything like that.

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